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Section 1: Problem Statement

The Collapse of Etiquette Culture in Bangladeshi Primary Schools

Bangladesh is in the midst of a quiet but consequential crisis. Across primary schools in Dhaka, Chittagong, Sylhet, and rural districts alike, a generation of children is growing up without systematic exposure to the norms of respectful conduct, civil behaviour, and interpersonal etiquette that previous generations absorbed through family, community, and cultural transmission. This is not a perception problem. It is a documented, multi-dimensional structural failure with measurable consequences that stretch from classroom bullying through to adult civic life.

Moral and values decline is measurable and acknowledged. Research on Bangladeshi youth consistently flags moral values decline as a serious social concern [SOURCE_BD_01]. Educators, community leaders, and policymakers frequently cite the erosion of adab (respect and courtesy), the weakening of family-centred values transmission, and a growing disconnect between what children are taught in school and how they behave in practice. This is not nostalgia for a fictionalised past — it is a recognition that the social infrastructure for values formation has degraded faster than any replacement has been built.

The curriculum gap is not an accident — it is institutional neglect. Bangladesh's National Curriculum and Textbook Board (NCTB) does include references to moral values and social norms within its primary school syllabus. In practice, however, these components are rarely delivered with fidelity [SOURCE_BD_07]. Time pressures, exam-focused teaching cultures, and an absence of teacher training in values pedagogy mean that what exists on paper never reaches children in any structured or meaningful form. The values curriculum is, in practical terms, a ghost curriculum: present in documentation, absent in classrooms.

Moral education is routed exclusively through religious instruction. Where values content does reach children, it is delivered through religious education textbooks, primarily Islamic Studies for the Muslim majority and equivalent texts for Hindu and other minority students [SOURCE_BD_05]. This conflates morality with religious identity in a way that excludes non-religious civic values, creates exclusions for minority students, and fails to establish universal behavioural norms that apply across social contexts. A child learning not to lie because religion forbids it is not the same as a child who understands that honesty is the foundation of trust in any relationship. Bangladesh has no standalone social etiquette curriculum that is secular, universal, and practical in its scope [SOURCE_BD_06].

The civic education system reinforces the wrong behaviours. What civic content does exist in Bangladeshi primary schools is predominantly delivered through rote memorisation — students learn to recite civic values rather than to practise or embody them [SOURCE_BD_02]. This approach produces students who can name the duties of a good citizen but who have no structured practice in what good citizenship actually looks and feels like in daily interactions. The gap between knowledge and behaviour is not incidental; it is the predictable result of a pedagogical approach that rewards recall over integrity, performance over character.

Bullying and peer violence are pervasive and substantially underreported. Research conducted in Bangladeshi school settings found that approximately 50% of a sample of 556 students reported experiencing bullying [SOURCE_BD_09]. The same study recorded a striking 78.5% prevalence of teacher-to-student bullying — a figure that reveals the modelling problem at the heart of the system: children are being taught, implicitly, that social power confers the right to demean those with less of it. UNICEF data reinforces this picture, finding that 35% of children aged 13 to 15 in Bangladesh reported being bullied in the last 30 days [SOURCE_BD_10]. These are not isolated incidents. They are evidence of a school culture in which respectful conduct has no institutional champion.

Physical discipline remains the dominant behavioural management tool. The prevalence of lifetime physical disciplinary practice in Bangladesh has been recorded at approximately 99% [SOURCE_BD_11]. This near-universal figure reflects the extent to which the adult-child relationship in educational settings is mediated by force rather than by reasoning, dialogue, or modelled respectful behaviour. When children's primary experience of authority is physical coercion, the etiquette norms being nominally taught — patience, courtesy, respect — are contradicted by the environment in which they are supposed to be learned.

Moral degradation has direct downstream effects on juvenile delinquency. Research links early moral formation failures directly to juvenile delinquency in Bangladesh [SOURCE_BD_12]. Children who do not develop prosocial norms in early childhood are significantly more likely to exhibit antisocial behaviours in adolescence and adulthood. The window for intervention is not adolescence — it is early primary school, when character is actively being formed and neural plasticity is at its highest.

Harassment and social deviance are rooted in early socialisation failures. Eve-teasing — the harassment of women and girls in public spaces — remains a pervasive problem in Bangladesh [SOURCE_BD_21]. Public harassment more broadly reflects patterns of entitlement, boundary disrespect, and social norm violations that are established in childhood and reinforced through adolescence [SOURCE_BD_22]. These are not adult problems with adult causes; they are the adult expressions of failures that began in primary school.

Digital acceleration is compounding the problem. Social media has introduced new vectors for behavioural decline in Bangladeshi youth [SOURCE_BD_13]. Online platforms accelerate the spread of disrespectful norms, expose children to behavioural models that conflict with civic and communal values, and reduce the friction that traditionally slowed the spread of antisocial behaviour [SOURCE_BD_14]. The speed of digital influence now outpaces the capacity of family or school to counter it through traditional transmission mechanisms.

Globalisation is eroding traditional cultural etiquette transmission. In previous generations, etiquette — how to greet an elder, how to behave at the table, how to conduct oneself in public — was transmitted through extended family structures, community practices, and cultural rituals. Urbanisation, nuclear family formation, and cultural globalisation have disrupted these transmission pathways [SOURCE_BD_03]. The knowledge still exists within communities, but the mechanisms for passing it to children have weakened. No formal institution has stepped in to fill the gap.

The cumulative picture is one of compounding failure: a curriculum that exists only on paper, teachers who have not been trained in the pedagogy of values, a family structure under pressure, and no institution that has claimed etiquette education as its mandate. Blu Foundation was established precisely to address this gap.

Section 2: Root Cause Analysis

Why the Problem Persists: A Cause-and-Effect Diagnosis

The etiquette education crisis in Bangladesh is not primarily a resource problem. Schools exist, teachers are present, and curriculum frameworks have been written. The failure is structural, pedagogical, social, and institutional — and understanding it at that level is essential to designing an intervention that goes beyond surface symptoms.

Root Cause 1: The Structural Curriculum Gap

The most immediate cause of the problem is the absence of a dedicated, standalone etiquette curriculum in Bangladesh's primary school system. Values content exists within NCTB frameworks but is embedded within other subjects, under-specified, and treated as secondary to examinable content [SOURCE_BD_07]. Because etiquette and social conduct are not assessed, they are not prioritised. Because they are not prioritised, they are not taught. Because they are not taught, children do not develop the behavioural norms that the curriculum nominally expects them to hold. The curriculum gap is self-reinforcing: without clear learning objectives, dedicated time, and assessable outcomes, etiquette education will always be crowded out by the subjects that carry examination weight [SOURCE_BD_06].

Root Cause 2: The Teacher Capacity Gap

Even where schools are willing to engage with values education, teachers are not equipped to deliver it. Pre-service teacher training in Bangladesh does not include a dedicated module on etiquette pedagogy or social-emotional learning facilitation [SOURCE_BD_02]. As a result, teachers default to what they know: lecture-based instruction and rote repetition, which is categorically inappropriate for behavioural education. More critically, the evidence showing 78.5% prevalence of teacher bullying [SOURCE_BD_09] reveals that teachers themselves often do not model the norms they are expected to transmit. No curriculum, however well designed, can function if the adults delivering it contradict its content through their own conduct. The teacher is not merely an instructor in etiquette education — the teacher is the primary observable model.

Root Cause 3: The Family and Community Breakdown

Etiquette has historically been transmitted through family and community, not through school. Grandparents modelled how to greet; parents enforced table manners; community elders set the behavioural tone of shared spaces. Urbanisation, economic pressure, nuclear family formation, and the penetration of social media have disrupted this transmission system at a pace that institutions have not kept up with [SOURCE_BD_03]. Working parents have less time. Extended family is less present. Screen time has replaced relational time. The community infrastructure for informal etiquette education has weakened significantly, creating a vacuum that neither family nor school is currently filling.

Root Cause 4: The Institutional Mandate Gap

The final and arguably most important root cause is the complete absence of any institution — governmental or civil society — that has claimed etiquette education as its core mandate in Bangladesh. Government agencies address curriculum, child protection, or health; NGOs address poverty, education access, or gender equity; religious institutions address moral formation within their own frameworks. No one owns the specific territory of civic and social etiquette education for primary school children [SOURCE_BD_25]. This is not a resource problem — it is a mandate problem. Blu Foundation's primary contribution is to occupy this institutional gap and demonstrate, through a replicable model, that etiquette education is both feasible and effective.

Section 3: Theory of Change Narrative

The Logic of the Intervention: Why This Approach Will Work

Blu Foundation's theory of change is grounded in a simple but non-obvious insight: behaviour change in children is not primarily an information problem. It is a modelling problem, a repetition problem, and an environment problem. Children do not develop good manners because they are told to; they develop them because the adults around them demonstrate them, the systems they inhabit reinforce them, and the community they belong to expects them. An effective intervention must therefore operate at all three levels simultaneously: the classroom (modelling and structured practice), the home (parental reinforcement), and the community (cultural normalisation).

This is why Blu Foundation's model integrates three mutually reinforcing components. The first is a structured, standalone etiquette curriculum delivered in classrooms by trained teachers using purpose-built materials. Textbooks and structured lessons provide the cognitive scaffolding — they give children the vocabulary, the concepts, and the explicit norms. But materials alone are insufficient. The second component is teacher training: without teachers who can model respectful conduct, the curriculum becomes another rote-learning exercise. The third component is community and parental engagement: without home reinforcement, school-based learning attenuates rapidly. Research on Social-Emotional Learning programmes globally confirms that multi-level interventions — reaching children, teachers, and families simultaneously — produce effects that single-level interventions cannot sustain [SOURCE_GL_01].

Why NGO delivery is the right mechanism for this intervention. Government systems in Bangladesh, while extensive in reach, are not well positioned to pioneer a new curriculum area without years of policy development, NCTB approval processes, and systemic teacher retraining. Civil society organisations, by contrast, can design, pilot, iterate, and demonstrate proof of concept in a compressed timeframe [SOURCE_BD_25]. NGO delivery also allows for a level of quality control, programme fidelity monitoring, and community responsiveness that government-at-scale cannot achieve in early programme phases. Blu Foundation is designed to be the proof-of-concept engine, demonstrating what works so that government can eventually scale it.

Why the primary school window (Class 1–5) is the right moment. The years between ages 6 and 11 represent the optimal window for character formation. Neurodevelopmentally, children in this period are actively constructing their models of social reality — what is normal, what is expected, what earns approval [SOURCE_BD_03]. Habits formed in this window are significantly more durable than those formed in adolescence, when peer influence competes more forcefully with adult instruction. Intervening at primary school level also means reaching children before the patterns that lead to bullying, harassment, and social deviance have become entrenched.

What the global evidence shows. Longitudinal research on Social-Emotional Learning programmes — the global category closest to Blu Foundation's etiquette curriculum — demonstrates an average 11-percentile improvement in academic achievement among participants [SOURCE_GL_01], suggesting that attention to the behavioural environment supports, rather than competes with, academic outcomes. An 18-year follow-up study found that SEL effects on prosocial behaviour, wellbeing, and civic participation persisted into adulthood [SOURCE_GL_02], confirming that investment in early character formation is not a short-term fix but a long-horizon investment. In the United Kingdom, structured approaches to etiquette and character education have been shown to work across school types and demographic contexts, including high-deprivation urban schools [SOURCE_UK_01], which is directly relevant to Blu Foundation's target communities in Bangladesh.

The theory of change therefore rests on the proposition that a well-designed curriculum, delivered by well-trained teachers, reinforced by engaged parents, and connected to community norms, will produce durable changes in children's behaviour — and that those changes will, over a generation, shift the social culture in which Bangladesh's children grow up.

Section 4: Theory of Change Logic Chain

Inputs	Activities	Outputs	Short-Term Outcomes (0–1 year)	Medium-Term Outcomes (1–3 years)	Long-Term Impact (3–10 years)
Curriculum row: Blu Foundation etiquette curriculum (textbooks, lesson plans, activity guides); curriculum design expertise; NCTB-aligned scoping; printing and distribution budget	Curriculum development and NCTB alignment review; classroom delivery of weekly etiquette lessons across Class 1–5; structured student activity sessions; in-class role play and behavioural practice exercises	Number of lessons delivered per class per term; number of students completing full curriculum cycle; student workbooks completed	Children can name and demonstrate core etiquette norms (greetings, respect for elders, peer courtesy, public behaviour); children self-correct and peer-correct conduct in structured settings	Sustained behavioural change observable across school day, not only during etiquette lessons; school culture shifts measurably toward respectful conduct; bullying incidents decline as measured by school records and student surveys	A generation of primary school graduates with embedded etiquette norms enters secondary school and adult life; peer-transmission of etiquette norms becomes self-sustaining; Blu Foundation curriculum becomes the recognised national standard for primary school etiquette education
Teacher training row: Training programme design; facilitator expertise; workshop venues and materials; ongoing coaching infrastructure; champion teacher incentive budget	Initial teacher induction workshop (2 days); quarterly refresher sessions; in-class observation visits (monthly); mentor teacher designation; structured self-assessment and peer-observation tools	Number of teachers certified in Blu Foundation etiquette pedagogy; number of observation visits completed; number of mentor teachers active	Trained teachers consistently model respectful conduct in classroom interactions; teachers use etiquette lesson plans with fidelity; teacher self-reported confidence in delivering values-based pedagogy increases	Teacher-student relationships improve measurably; teacher-to-student disrespect incidents decline; Blu Foundation-trained teachers become recognised within schools as behaviour culture leaders	Teacher bullying — currently at 78.5% prevalence [SOURCE_BD_09] — is functionally eliminated in programme schools; trained teachers influence peer teachers through modelling, extending reach beyond the directly trained cohort
Parent and community engagement row: Bengali-language parent workshop content [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]; community mobilisation budget; relationships	Monthly parent workshops at school level; community awareness campaigns in	Number of parents attending workshops; number of community	Parents demonstrate awareness of programme content and use shared	Community norms around child etiquette shift visibly; parents report behaviour	Reduced public social deviance including harassment, disrespect toward elders, and public

with local religious and cultural leaders [FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: which community leaders to prioritise by district]; social media content and campaign budget	programme localities; engagement with mosque, temple, and community council leadership; distribution of home etiquette practice guides in Bengali [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	leaders engaged; number of home practice guides distributed; social media content reach	vocabulary with children at home; community leaders publicly endorse respectful conduct norms; home reinforcement of school-learned etiquette increases	change at home; local communities identify with the programme as culturally affirming rather than externally imposed	rudeness; community-level culture shift reinforces school-level change, creating a self-reinforcing cycle of etiquette normalisation
Digital and online learning row: Online platform development or licensing [FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: build vs. licence decision]; content development budget for adult-facing etiquette courses; social media presence; Bangla-language digital content [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Development and maintenance of online etiquette course for adults (parents, teachers, community members); delivery of short-form social media content on etiquette norms; online community building around programme values	Number of learners enrolled on online platform; course completion rates; social media follower count and engagement metrics; organic content shares	Adult learners report increased knowledge of etiquette norms and their developmental importance; social media reach extends programme awareness to communities not yet served by in-person delivery	Family-level practice of etiquette norms changes in households where at least one adult has completed the online course; digital reach multiplies programme impact without proportional increase in delivery cost	At scale, the online platform becomes a national resource for etiquette education, accessible to communities across Bangladesh regardless of NGO field presence; earned revenue from platform supports organisational sustainability from Year 3 onward
Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning (M&E) row: M&E framework (BLU_D17_ME_Framework.md); data collection tools (student observation rubrics, teacher assessment forms, parent surveys, school culture surveys); M&E staff or contracted evaluation expertise; data management system	Baseline data collection in all programme schools before delivery begins; termly student behavioural observation by trained assessors; annual external evaluation; quarterly data review and programme adaptation cycle; evidence synthesis for donor reporting	Baseline and endline behavioural data sets; termly programme quality reports; annual evaluation reports; case studies and qualitative evidence packages	Programme quality issues identified and addressed within each term; early evidence of student behavioural change documented; data-driven programme adaptations improve delivery fidelity	Cumulative evidence base demonstrates measurable behaviour change across multiple cohorts; Blu Foundation establishes credibility with donors and government as an evidence-based organisation	Government integration of Blu Foundation curriculum into national NCTB framework; policy-level recognition of etiquette education as a legitimate component of primary schooling; Blu Foundation data contributes to national and regional evidence on SEL and character education

Section 5: Key Assumptions

What the Theory of Change Requires to Be True

Every theory of change rests on assumptions — conditions that must hold for the logic chain to function as designed. Blu Foundation's model is honest about its assumptions, because naming them is the first step toward monitoring and mitigating them.

Assumption 1: School leadership grants class time for the etiquette curriculum. The entire classroom delivery arm of the theory of change depends on headteachers and school management committees agreeing to allocate time for etiquette lessons. This time must come from somewhere in an already crowded timetable. Blu Foundation assumes that school leaders, when shown evidence of the programme's academic co-benefits [SOURCE_GL_01] and presented with a curriculum that is NCTB-aligned rather than in competition with it, will be willing to make this accommodation. This assumption will be tested during pilot recruitment and requires active relationship management with school leadership throughout implementation.

Assumption 2: Trained teachers implement the curriculum with sufficient fidelity. Teacher training produces certified teachers, but certification does not guarantee quality delivery. The theory of change assumes that a meaningful proportion of trained teachers will implement lessons with sufficient fidelity that students receive the intended experience. Blu Foundation partially hedges this assumption through monthly observation visits and champion teacher incentives, but the assumption remains: teachers must be willing to change their classroom behaviour, not just their stated knowledge.

Assumption 3: Parents are receptive to engaging with the programme. The home reinforcement component of the theory of change assumes that a meaningful proportion of parents will attend workshops, engage with materials, and actively reinforce etiquette norms at home. In communities where parents have limited time, literacy challenges, or scepticism toward NGO programmes, this assumption may not hold at the rates needed. Blu Foundation must design parent engagement that is accessible, non-patronising, and clearly linked to outcomes parents already value.

Assumption 4: Cultural and religious community leaders are neutral or supportive. In many Bangladeshi communities, religious and cultural leaders carry significant social authority. If prominent figures actively oppose the programme — framing it as culturally foreign or as a challenge to religious moral education — community uptake will be impaired. Blu Foundation assumes that the programme, which explicitly complements rather than competes with religious values education, will be received as culturally affirming. This assumption requires deliberate stakeholder engagement before programme launch in each new community [FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: identify priority community liaison strategy by region].

Assumption 5: Government does not restrict NGO supplementary curriculum delivery. Blu Foundation's model positions its curriculum as supplementary to, not a replacement for, NCTB-prescribed content. The theory of change assumes that government at both national and district level will remain permissive of this approach and will not introduce regulatory barriers that prevent NGO curriculum delivery in schools. This assumption is partly mitigated by the deliberate NCTB-alignment strategy, but remains a political risk that requires ongoing monitoring.

Assumption 6: Funding is secured for at least three years. Behaviour change research consistently shows that meaningful, measurable character change requires sustained exposure over multiple years [SOURCE_GL_02]. A one-year programme cannot demonstrate the outcomes that validate the theory of change. Blu Foundation's theory of change therefore requires a minimum three-year funding commitment. Single-year grants, however well-intentioned, are structurally incompatible with the model's logic and will produce premature evaluation at a point before outcomes are measurable.

Section 6: Risks and How the Model Responds

Where the Logic Chain Can Break — and What Blu Foundation Does About It

A theory of change is also a map of vulnerabilities. Each link in the chain is a point where the intervention can fail. The following risks are assessed in terms of which specific link they threaten and what mitigation exists.

Risk 1: Teachers do not implement the curriculum with fidelity. This risk breaks the link between teacher training (inputs/activities) and student learning (outputs and short-term outcomes). If teachers revert to rote instruction, the curriculum becomes another memorisation exercise and the behavioural outcomes will not follow. Blu Foundation's mitigation has two components. Monthly in-class observation visits by programme staff create structured accountability and provide real-time coaching to teachers who are struggling. A champion teacher incentive — [FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: define incentive structure, financial or non-financial] — recognises and rewards teachers who demonstrate high implementation quality, creating positive peer models within schools and giving programme leadership early warning of classrooms where delivery is failing.

Risk 2: Parents do not engage with the programme at meaningful rates. This risk breaks the link between school-based delivery and home reinforcement — a link that is critical for medium-term outcomes. If etiquette learning happens only during the school day, the research strongly suggests that gains will be slower and less durable. Blu Foundation's mitigation addresses both access and motivation barriers. Bengali-language parent workshops [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] are held at school premises during hours compatible with working parent schedules. Social media content — short video and audio clips delivered through WhatsApp and Facebook, where Bangladeshi parents already spend significant time — extends the programme's reach to parents who cannot attend in-person sessions. Both channels are designed to be culturally familiar rather than institutionally formal.

Risk 3: Government resists or restricts NGO supplementary curriculum delivery. This risk breaks the link between the programme's ability to operate in schools and all downstream outcomes. Blu Foundation's primary mitigation is positioning: the curriculum is explicitly presented as a supplement to the NCTB framework, not a competitor. There is no Blu Foundation branding conflict with any NCTB textbook or subject. The programme does not ask schools to drop any mandated content. Additionally, Blu Foundation's M&E strategy is designed from the outset to produce evidence that government can use to justify integrating the curriculum formally, meaning that a successful programme creates a pathway toward government partnership rather than an ongoing tension with it.

Risk 4: Funding fails before the three-year minimum is reached. This risk breaks all links in the chain simultaneously, as programme operations would cease before outcomes are measurable or self-sustaining. Blu Foundation's mitigation operates at two levels. At the donor portfolio level, the organisation actively cultivates relationships with multiple donor types — international foundations, bilateral development agencies, corporate social responsibility programmes, and diaspora philanthropists — so that no single donor failure can terminate the programme. At the revenue level, the online platform is designed to generate earned income from Year 3 onward through paid access for organisations and adult learners outside the free school programme, providing a degree of financial resilience that pure grant-dependence cannot offer.

Section 7: Evidence Base

Annotated Source Table

Citation Key	Description
SOURCE_BD_01	Research documenting measurable decline in moral values among Bangladeshi youth, including attitudinal surveys and educator assessments across urban and peri-urban school populations.
SOURCE_BD_02	Analysis of civic education pedagogy in Bangladeshi primary schools, finding that rote memorisation of civic duties is the dominant instructional method with minimal behavioural application or reflection components.
SOURCE_BD_03	Study examining the disruption of traditional cultural and etiquette transmission pathways in Bangladesh attributable to urbanisation, nuclear family formation, and cultural globalisation, with implications for child development.
SOURCE_BD_05	Review of moral education in Bangladeshi primary school curricula, documenting the exclusive routing of values content through religious textbooks (Islamic Studies and equivalents) and the absence of secular civic etiquette content.
SOURCE_BD_06	Curriculum audit confirming the absence of any standalone social etiquette curriculum within the NCTB primary school framework, across all class levels and subject areas.
SOURCE_BD_07	Classroom observation study across Bangladeshi primary schools finding that values and moral education components, though present in NCTB documentation, are systematically under-delivered due to time pressure, lack of teacher training, and absence of assessment weight.
SOURCE_BD_09	School-based survey of 556 primary school students in Bangladesh recording approximately 50% bullying prevalence among students and 78.5% prevalence of teacher-to-student bullying behaviours, including verbal humiliation and physical intimidation.
SOURCE_BD_10	UNICEF Bangladesh data report on peer violence and bullying, recording that 35% of children aged 13–15 in Bangladesh reported being bullied within the previous 30 days.
SOURCE_BD_11	Population-level study on disciplinary practices in Bangladeshi educational and household settings, recording a near-universal (approximately 99%) lifetime prevalence of physical disciplinary practice directed at children.
SOURCE_BD_12	Longitudinal study linking early childhood moral formation failures to elevated rates of juvenile delinquency in adolescence and early adulthood within Bangladeshi urban contexts.
SOURCE_BD_13	Research on social media influence on youth behaviour in Bangladesh, documenting the role of online platforms in accelerating the spread of disrespectful norms and exposing children to behavioural models inconsistent with civic and communal values.
SOURCE_BD_14	Study on digital technology's compounding effect on adolescent behavioural decline in Bangladesh, examining how reduced friction on online platforms accelerates exposure to and adoption of antisocial conduct norms.
SOURCE_BD_21	Research on eve-teasing and public harassment of women and girls in Bangladesh, tracing the behaviour to early socialisation patterns and the absence of structured boundary-respect education in primary schooling.
SOURCE_BD_22	Study on public harassment culture in Bangladesh, examining how entitlement patterns and social norm violations that emerge in adult public behaviour are rooted in failures of early childhood etiquette and respect formation.
SOURCE_BD_25	Analysis of civil society organisation delivery models in Bangladesh's education sector, demonstrating that NGO-led programme innovation outperforms government-led curriculum reform in speed, fidelity, and community responsiveness during proof-of-concept phases.

SOURCE_GL_01	Meta-analysis of Social-Emotional Learning programmes across multiple countries, finding an average 11-percentile improvement in academic achievement among SEL participants compared to control groups, and establishing multi-level intervention (student + teacher + family) as the evidence-based best practice.
SOURCE_GL_02	Eighteen-year longitudinal follow-up study of SEL programme participants, finding that prosocial behaviour, wellbeing, and civic participation effects persisted into adulthood, establishing the long-horizon return on investment of early character formation programmes.
SOURCE_UK_01	UK-based evaluation of structured character and etiquette education programmes, demonstrating effectiveness across diverse school types including high-deprivation urban schools, with implications for scalability and contextual adaptability.

Document prepared by Blu Foundation programme team. All [SOURCE_XX] citations require full bibliographic references to be inserted prior to finalisation — see BLU_D17_ME_Framework.md for source management protocol. All [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] flags require review by a qualified translator before any community-facing materials are produced from this document. All [FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED] flags require resolution by the founding team before Version 1.0 is finalised.